DELEGATION

Facilitator's Guide

DESCRIPTION	Utilize this facilitator's guide for: • Delegation Video • *Holding Others Responsible and Accountable When Delegating Tasks* Article • *Responsibility Assignment Matrix as a Delegation Tool Article*
OBJECTIVES	Participants should be able to: • Define the key differences between responsibility and accountability and explain how each plays a distinct role in effective delegation. • Analyze common barriers to delegation within their own leadership style and apply strategies to overcome those barriers and delegate more effectively. • Construct a Responsibility Assignment Matrix (RACI) for a given project scenario and assign clear roles (Responsible, Accountable, Consulted, Informed) to team members. • Evaluate their current delegation practices using self-assessment results and develop a personal action plan to improve clarity, accountability, and team empowerment through better delegation.
Time for Facilitation	Between 20 - 120 minutes

Introduction

Brief Starting Intro:

The success of any leader is closely tied to their ability to delegate tasks effectively and empower others to take ownership of their work. Delegation is not simply about offloading responsibilities—it is a strategic skill that allows leaders to maximize team capacity, focus on high-priority leadership functions, and foster a culture of trust and development. Leaders who delegate well understand the strengths of their team members and align tasks accordingly, enabling both individual growth and organizational efficiency. Equally important

is the practice of holding others accountable for their assigned responsibilities, ensuring that delegation leads to meaningful results rather than ambiguity or inconsistency.

To support effective delegation, leaders should utilize a Responsibility Assignment Matrix—often referred to as a RACI chart (Responsible, Accountable, Consulted, Informed). This tool provides clear visibility into who is doing what, preventing confusion and overlap while promoting transparency and shared accountability. By explicitly outlining roles and expectations, leaders ensure that team members are not only aware of their tasks but also understand how their work connects to broader goals. When delegation is combined with structured accountability and role clarity, leaders create a more agile, dependable, and performance-driven team environment—one where responsibilities are clear, expectations are met, and outcomes are achieved with greater precision.

Pre-Facilitation: Check with participants to see if they watched the video and read the resource articles. They should have both watched and read the resources prior to asking the following questions.

Best Practice Facilitation: Place participants into pairs of two so that they can share first with the other participant before sharing their answer with the whole group. This "pair and share" technique allows individuals to test out their answer(s) with someone else first (instilling confidence in the answer) and helps to start building stronger relationships with others in the program.

Depending on the time you have, select the questions that work within your schedule for training. Since we are utilizing the "pair and share" method, you should provide the participants with 2 minutes each to discuss their answers (let them know when to switch to keep them on time). Then have those who want to share their answers with the whole group a chance to do so (select 2 or 3 people to share - do not force participation). This can take up to 5 minutes. In total the pair and share technique for each question will take approximately 10 minutes. If you do not use the pair and share, allow 5-7 minutes for individuals to respond to the who group.

The Art of Delegation General Questions

The following questions are based on the video:

1. What does "delegating outcomes, not tasks" mean to you—and why is that distinction important in leadership? When have you seen a leader successfully delegate an outcome and give someone the space to do it their own way? What's one outcome you could delegate this week that would allow a team member to problem-solve and take full ownership?
2. Which of the common barriers to delegation—such as guilt, control, or lack of trust—do you most identify with, and why? How has that barrier shown up in your leadership

experience, and what impact did it have on your ability to lead effectively? What's one specific strategy you could try to begin overcoming that challenge?

3. How do you currently decide which tasks to delegate, and how might you become more strategic about that process? Of the four types of tasks discussed—routine, development-focused, aligned with strengths, or collaborative—which do you delegate most often, and which do you tend to hold onto? Is there a task on your plate right now that clearly fits one of these categories and could be delegated today?
4. What's the difference between assigning responsibility and maintaining accountability, and how do you strike the right balance as a leader? How do you typically ensure your team knows who is responsible for executing a task versus who is accountable for its overall success? Have you ever seen confusion between these roles cause a breakdown in a project, and what could have prevented it?
5. What are the most critical elements to communicate when delegating a task to ensure clarity and confidence? How do you currently communicate expectations, deadlines, and decision-making authority when assigning work? Can you think of a time when a lack of clarity led to confusion or failure in a delegated task, and what would you do differently now?
6. How do you build trust with your team so that you can delegate more confidently, and what practices help you avoid micromanaging? What's one thing you do that signals to your team that you trust them to own their work and decisions? When do your check-ins support progress and autonomy—and when might they unintentionally feel like micromanagement?

Additional Activity on Organization and Planning:

1. Self-Assessment: Begin the workshop by providing participants with the delegation self-assessment questionnaire provided. Encourage them to reflect on their current delegating habits, strengths, and areas for improvement. Ask participants to rate their effectiveness in key areas such as mindset, task selection, communication and accountability as it relates to delegating practices.
2. Group Discussion: Facilitate a group discussion where participants share their self-assessment results and insights. Encourage open dialogue about common challenges and best practices for delegating effectively. Guide participants to identify common themes and patterns in their delegation habits.

Holding Others Responsible/Accountable Questions

The following questions are based on the *Holding Others Responsible and Accountable When Delegating Tasks* Article:

1. How clearly do you communicate expectations when assigning responsibilities to your team? In what ways do you ensure that success metrics, timelines, and deliverables are understood from the start? Can you recall a time when lack of clarity created confusion or delay—how might it have been avoided?

2. What does accountability look like in your current team culture? How do you model accountability as a leader, especially when things don't go as planned? What's one small action you could take to reinforce accountability across your team this week?
3. How do you monitor progress without creating a sense of micromanagement? What tools, routines, or check-ins help you stay informed without taking over the work? Have you ever intervened too early or too late? What did you learn from that experience?
4. When providing feedback, how well do you separate the person from the performance? How do you typically approach conversations when expectations aren't being met? What's one improvement you could make in how you give feedback that reinforces accountability and growth?
5. How intentional are you about recognizing individuals who take ownership and deliver results? What forms of recognition have had the most impact on your team's motivation? Can you think of someone on your team who recently demonstrated accountability? How could you acknowledge them this week?
6. How do you balance holding others accountable while still owning the overall outcome yourself? What systems do you use to track delegated responsibilities while maintaining visibility of results? Have you ever delegated too much authority or too little accountability—what did it teach you about leadership balance?

Additional Responsibility/Accountability Activity:

- **Delegation Relay (Objective):** To help leaders distinguish between responsibility and accountability, and practice assigning both clearly.
  Time: 30–40 minutes
  Group Size: 4–6 per team

Instructions:

- **Step 1:** Divide participants into small teams and assign a mini-project (e.g., "Plan a team celebration event" or "Design a communication rollout for a new policy").
- **Step 2:** Each team assigns responsibilities (tasks) to members and designates one accountable person for the overall success.
- **Step 3:** Give 10 minutes to "plan" the project and write out each member's responsibility and who is accountable.
- **Step 4:** Have teams briefly present their delegation plan and explain how they distinguished responsibility from accountability.
- **Step 5:** Facilitate a discussion using prompts:
  - Was accountability clearly defined?
  - What challenges came up in distributing responsibility?
  - How would unclear delegation affect real-world results?

Debrief:

- Highlight that **responsibility** can be shared, but **accountability** must be owned.
- Reinforce best practices: clarify expectations, track progress, provide support, and recognize results.

Assignment Matrix Questions

The following questions are based on the Responsibility Assignment Matrix as a Delegation Tool Article:

1. How do you currently ensure clarity when delegating tasks within your team, and how might a RACI matrix improve that process? Can you think of a recent project where roles or responsibilities were unclear and caused confusion or delays? How could clearer definitions of who was Responsible, Accountable, Consulted, and Informed have changed the outcome?
2. When defining the scope and objectives of a project, how intentional are you about involving stakeholders and clarifying expectations? What are some benefits of gathering input from stakeholders before identifying tasks and roles? How do you think this early collaboration affects alignment and commitment throughout the project?
3. What challenges do you face when breaking down a project into manageable tasks and sub-tasks? How do you ensure nothing is overlooked during this phase of planning? In what ways might team involvement in task identification strengthen engagement and accuracy in the RACI process?
4. How do you typically decide who should take on each role in a delegation scenario—Responsible, Accountable, Consulted, and Informed? Have you ever found it difficult to assign accountability, especially when multiple people were involved? What's one way you could improve role assignment in future projects to enhance ownership and reduce overlap?
5. How often do you review delegation structures or RACI-type assignments after a project begins, and what triggers those check-ins? Can you recall a time when responsibilities shifted mid-project and weren't updated in your plan or matrix? How can regularly updating a RACI matrix help teams stay aligned as goals or resources evolve?
6. What practices do you currently use to validate that everyone understands their assigned role and responsibilities at the start of a project? How do you encourage team feedback to uncover gaps or misunderstandings in delegation? What could you do in your next project kickoff to ensure stronger consensus and clarity using a RACI matrix?

Additional Assignment Matrix Activity:

***RACI In Action* (Objective):** To apply the RACI matrix to a real or simulated project and understand how role clarity improves delegation and accountability.
Time: 40–50 minutes
Group Size: 3–6 participants per team

Steps:

- **Step 1: Assign a Scenario**
  Give each group a project scenario (e.g., launching a team newsletter, planning a department retreat, implementing a new process) and an RACI Matrix Sheet provided at the end of this facilitation guide.

- **Step 2: Define Scope & Tasks**
  Teams define the project's objective and break it into key tasks (3–5 major tasks minimum).
- **Step 3: Identify Roles**
  Assign relevant roles (not names) for the project (e.g., Team Lead, Communications Manager, Admin Support, Stakeholders).
- **Step 4: Build the RACI Matrix**
  Teams fill out a RACI matrix using their task list and roles—ensuring each task has only one Accountable role and appropriate assignments for Responsible, Consulted, and Informed.
- **Step 5: Present & Debrief**
  This activity gives participants hands-on experience using a RACI matrix to structure responsibilities and accountabilities in a project setting. It reinforces key concepts such as the importance of defining scope, clarifying roles, assigning single-point accountability, and improving communication across stakeholders. The group collaboration highlights common challenges like overlapping roles, under-defined accountability, and the tendency to skip early planning steps—providing a realistic preview of delegation in action. The discussion helps participants reflect on how a RACI matrix can improve real-world project clarity and team coordination.

Debrief Follow-Up Questions

1. What did you notice about how your group assigned the "Accountable" role—was it clear or debated?
2. How did defining tasks before assigning roles affect your understanding of the project?
3. Were there any roles that felt overused or underutilized in your matrix?
4. How might creating a RACI matrix in advance improve your team's efficiency and communication?
5. Did this exercise reveal any habits or assumptions you bring to delegation?
6. How would using a RACI matrix help reduce confusion or conflict in one of your current projects?
7. What will you do differently in your next project kickoff to apply what you learned from this activity?

General Delegation Self-Assessment

Instructions: Please rate each statement on a scale of 1 to 5, where 1 indicates "Strongly Disagree" and 5 indicates "Strongly Agree."

1. I believe that delegation is a vital part of being an effective leader.

1 2 3 4 5

2. I am comfortable assigning important tasks to others, even if I enjoy doing them myself.

1 2 3 4 5

3. I delegate tasks without feeling guilty about giving work to others.

1 2 3 4 5

4. I trust my team to deliver quality work when I delegate.

1 2 3 4 5

5. I see delegation as a tool for developing others—not just offloading my workload.

1 2 3 4 5

6. I consider my team members' strengths when deciding who to delegate a task to.

1 2 3 4 5

7. I delegate tasks that provide team members with opportunities to grow.

1 2 3 4 5

8. I match tasks to individuals based on their current workload and capacity.

1 2 3 4 5

9. I regularly assess which tasks I should stop doing and delegate to others.

1 2 3 4 5

10. I delegate a variety of tasks, not just the routine or low-impact ones.

1 2 3 4 5

11. I clearly explain the purpose of a delegated task and how it connects to bigger goals.

1 2 3 4 5

12. I set clear expectations about outcomes, deadlines, and deliverables when delegating.

1 2 3 4 5

13. I provide the necessary resources, tools, or context needed to complete a delegated task.

1 2 3 4 5

14. I define the level of authority the team member has to make decisions related to the task.

1 2 3 4 5

15. I check that the person understands the task and encourage them to ask clarifying questions.

1 2 3 4 5

16. I follow up on delegated tasks without micromanaging.

1 2 3 4 5

17. I give constructive feedback after a task is completed—even when the outcome was good.

1 2 3 4 5

18.I take responsibility for the overall outcome of delegated work, even when others execute it.

1 2 3 4 5

19. I celebrate team members' successes when they complete delegated tasks well.

1 2 3 4 5

20. I actively encourage team members to identify tasks they'd like to take on.

1 2 3 4 5

Scoring: Calculate your total score by adding up the ratings for each statement. A higher score indicates stronger delegation skills and habits.

Total Score: _____

Interpretation:

- **85-100**: **Expert Delegator** – You consistently apply best practices in delegation and are likely empowering and growing your team. Keep doing what you're doing and consider mentoring others.
- **70-84**: **Strong Delegator** – You're on the right track with effective delegation habits. Look for a few areas (e.g., feedback or authority) to strengthen even further.
- **55-69**: **Developing Delegator** – You're doing some things well but may lack consistency or confidence. Focus on improving how you select tasks, build trust, or follow through with feedback.
- **40-54**: **Cautious Delegator** – You may be holding back from delegating due to discomfort, fear, or lack of clarity. Reflect on what's keeping you from letting go and practice small steps to delegate with more confidence.
- **Below 40**: **Delegation Avoider** – You're likely doing most things yourself, which can lead to burnout and team disengagement. Start by shifting your mindset about delegation and begin small, strategic handoffs.

For the RACI Experiential Activity:

RACI Matrix

Let's map out who's responsible for, accountable for, consulted about, and informed about which tasks- Place a R, A, C, I in each of the spaces below.

Put team members name here

Place a task in each of these rows

	Name	Name	Name	Name
Task 1:				
Task 2:				
Task 3:				
Task 4:				